School of Computing

Module Code	M21267
Module Title	BUSINESS INFORMATION SYSTEMS SECURITY
Module Coordinator Other lecturers	Martin Sparrius <martin.sparrius@port.ac.uk >
Assessment Item number	Item 1
Assessment Title	BISS report
Date Issued	January 2024

Schedule and Deliverables

Item	Value	Format	Deadline	Late deadline ECF deadline
Report Proposal	70%	A single PDF file	10/05/2023 23:00	24/05/2023 23:00
Main Report		A single PDF file	10/05/2023 23:00	24/05/2023 23:00
Engagment		Moodle	10/05/2023 23:00	24/05/2023 23:00

Notes and Advice

- The Extenuating Circumstances procedure is there to support you if you have had any circumstances (problems) that have been serious or significant enough to prevent you from attending, completing or submitting an assessment on time. If you complete an Extenuating Circumstances Form (ECF) for this assessment, it is important that you use the correct module code, item number and deadline (not the late deadline) given above.
- ASDAC are available to any students who disclose a disability or require additional support for their academic studies with a good set of resources on the ASDAC moodle site
- The University takes any form of academic misconduct (such as plagiarism or cheating) seriously, so please make sure your work is your own. Please ensure you adhere to our *Code of Student Behaviour* and watch the video on Plagiarism.
- Any material included in your coursework should be fully cited and referenced in **APA 7** format. Detailed advice on referencing is available from the library, also see TECFAC 08 Plagiarism.
- Any material submitted that does not meet format or submission guidelines, or falls outside of the submission deadline could be subject to a cap on your overall result or disqualification entirely.
- If you need additional assistance, you can ask your personal tutor, student engagement officer ana.baker@port.ac.uk, academic tutor xia.han@port.ac.uk or your lecturers.
- If you are concerned about your mental well-being, please contact our Well-being service.

BISS Module Assessment 2022-23

The Module assessment will consist of 3 components (70% of Module) within which students will produce a report on a chosen current security issue facing business, and a final exam (30% of Module) which assesses understanding of the wider set of topics within the L.O.s for the Module. The strategy is based around the notion of students embedding the knowledge and understanding attained during the Module delivery by making choices regarding technology, strategy, cost and effectiveness.

The Report:
Students will conduct research into a defined topic, or a student-selected topic area, and then produce a report supporting and demonstrating their in-depth investigation. The students will reflect on their decisions, justifying their approach and discussing the professional, ethical issues and standards applied to their strategy.

There will be an opporttunity for students to get feedback on their investigation, including an initial proposal defining the security topic being investigated. The word count for each component will be:

- proposal (500 words)
- the main report (2,500 words)

Report Marks and Deliverables
This will consist of a staged submission to enable constructive feedback to be given to students. This consists of an initial report to be handed in for formative feedback in week 9, the main report on week 12 and an engagement mark compliled from their interaction with various Moodle tasks.

a) Initial Report (10 marks) detailing topic selection, issues and expected method and identification of initial sources of information. The report proposal should be approximately 500 words. This will be handed in during teaching week 9 via Moodle in time to get some feedback after the Easter Break. The proposal should contain:
    - The topic you plan to research
    - The topic's importance within the current IT environment
    - Potential risks and their implications for your chosen topic
    - Two key pieces of literature that you have found to support your research into the topic

    The initial report would expect to be supported by references.

b) Main body of report (80 marks) consisting of:-

- Final Report (50 marks): Students will conduct research into their chosen security related area (guidance and details about topic selection is below) and produce a report consisting of a critical evaluation of the topic including items such as identification of (where relevant to the topic) current issues, technologies, protocols, examples, trends, weaknesses, implications, potential impacts, solutions or anything else pertinent to the topic. Note students are not necessarily expected to cover all of the above, just those that are deemed relevant to the topic investigated.
- Reflection on decisions, topic, approach, limitations and investigation.Note students are not necessarily expected to cover all of these, just those that are deemed relevant. (15 marks)
- Discussion of relevant professional, social, ethical issues and any relevant standards to the topic investigated in the report (15 marks)
- Students may wish to use appropriate heading for each of these sections in their report.

c) Engagment grade
This will be graded on a sliding scale and take into account:

- The number of attempted Moodle tasks
- The quality of these responses

Please include a word count at the end of the reports and abstract. Items in the appendix and the reference list are not counted in the word counts. Penalties may be applied to excessively long or short pieces of work. It is suggested that students allocate a relative and appropriate number of words for each section (e.g. suggest allocating 10% of report words for a section giving 10% of marks).

Students can use bullet points, tables, figures and diagrams where suitable to inform their arguments and present information. Further supporting material may be included in an appendix to the report if required. In particular, outputs and results of analysis using any of the techniques applied in the seminar sessions can be included in the appendix to aid discussion in the reports.

Students must use appropriate referencing of material used in their report. Poor referencing will attract mark penalties.

Hand-in dates:

The Report Proposal: is to be handed into Moodle between 22nd March 2024 23:00 and Friday 10th May 2024 23:00

Main report: should be handed into Moodle by Friday 10th May 2024 23:00

Online Exam: To be confirmed near the time (Check your timetable)

Feedback on the submission will aim to be within the University 20 working days guidelines. Note that this year course work will be handed in electronically. We will endeavour to meet the 20 day guidelines for feedback but practical timing problems may impact this. Also note that students should ensure they have their students number on their handed in elements to help with giving appropriate feedback to students.

Assessment Guidance:-

Submission requirements
All assignments must meet the following requirements:

a) The first page of your submission MUST include the following:
    - Your student ID number
    - Course name
    - Module title
    - Assessment title
    - Submission date
    - Word count
b) When producing your coursework, use a black font point size 12, 1.5 or double line spacing and adequate margins for annotation.
c) Your student ID number must be in the header of each page.
d) Page numbers should be included in the the footer
e) Filename should be student number_courseworktype eg. **UPxxxxxx_report or UPxxxxxxx_abstract** depending of the coursework you are submitting.

Plagiarism and Poor Scholarship

This piece of work requires you to conduct research on your chosen topic. You are expected to understand how to reference using the Harvard APA V7 format. Therefore, marks will be deducted for poor scholarship and NO marks will be awarded for the entire assignment if ANY part of it is found to be directly copied from printed or published work or another student.

Use respected websites, and sources, where possible for your information gathering. To avoid plagiarism rewrite using your own words, but ensure where you have used the ideas of others you acknowledge the source within the text and provide the full source in the references at the end of the document (using Harvard APA V7 format). The majority of your document will need to be referenced, unless the idea is an original one of your own. If you are not sure of how to reference the library provides some useful information and guidance (including an online resource).

Presentation

Proof read your work for spelling, grammar and English prior to submission as clarity of expression is an important part of writing reports and presenting the results of your research and investigation.

Anonymity

All coursework should be anonymous, therefore do not put your name on your work. Only identify your work by putting your Student ID number in the footer of the document(s).

General guidance

The analysis you perform and the suggestions you propose are limited by major constraints.

> **Information** – The amount of information you can gather for this work is limited (e.g. in available time and resources). Remember, real world decisions usually have to be based on incomplete information.
>
> **Assumptions -** The number of assumptions you make will affect your analysis. Good rational assumptions are a key ingredient in good solutions, since there is never enough information available. You should identify and explain your rationale for any assumptions that you make.

Defined Topics for Investigation:

Students can choose from this list of topics for their investigation, alternatively students can negotiate with the tutor an alternative suitable topic for investigation.

Defined topic list:

1. A new security protocol, cryptography or technology
2. Evaluation of a new technology from a BISS perspective (you have to identify what the new technology is)
3. A new specific security threat and corresponding security solution affecting businesses
4. A **specific** biometric security technology, problem or solution (note not a general coverage of biometrics!)
5. A future security technology, problem or solution within a specific domain, business sector or application area
6. Database security within a specific domain, business or business sector
7. Evaluation issues relating to a specific compliance with standards within the context of BISS
8. Forensic evaluation issues relating to a specific business sector

Students can discuss their ideas for suitable topics with the tutors in the tutorial sessions. The general principles applied are that the topics should be related to BISS and that they should be fairly focussed topics. Indeed, difficult and challenging current topics will be looked at more favourably in the marking than ‘easy’ general previously well investigated topics.

BISS Assessment marking scheme:

Report Proposal (10 marks)

Marking guideline:	Comments
The initial report should contain *a) topic selection, outlining the chosen security topic for investigation,* *b) issues and an indication of why it is relevant* *c) expected method indicating how the topic will be investigated* *To achieve high marks students should demonstrate initial understanding of topic area, supported by references, examples, discussion or anything else relevant, plus thoughtful comments on issues and investigation methods.* *Penalties will be applied to excessively short or long reports*	/10

Main body of report (80 marks)

Marking guideline:	Comments
Main findings: ***Very good to Excellent report (39-50marks):****For top marks students should demonstrate an appropriate investigation into their chosen security related area, containing appropriate critical evaluation, and a selection of items such as identification and coverage of, where relevant to the topic,current issues, technologies, protocols, examples, trends, weaknesses, solutions or anything else pertinent to the topic. Students are not necessarily expected to cover all of these above, but the report should be consistent, the arguments fit together, show a founded, critical evaluation and have good structure and English.* ***Medium to Good report (26-40 marks):*** *Some of the items but lacking in either breadth or depth. Would still expect some merit in either of the following: critical evaluation, and a selection of items such as identification and coverage of, where relevant to the topic,current issues, technologies, protocols, examples, trends, weaknesses, solutions or anything else pertinent to the topic.* ***Poor to Medium report (0-25 marks):*** *As above but lacking in some key aspects of the investigation, representation or critical evaluation. Poorer marks are likely to lack both depth and breadth and demonstrate weak foundation in investigation of topic area.* *As an indication there will be 1-5 marks for each item included.*	/50
Reflection (15 marks)*: on decisions, topic, approach, limitations and investigation. For good marks the reflection should demonstrate coherent discussion and argument of issues related to decisions, topic, approach and investigation as appropriate. As an indication there will be 1-3 marks for each item included.*	/15
Discussion of relevant professional, social, ethical issues (15 marks)*: and any relevant standards to the topic investigated in the report. As an indication there will be 1-3 marks for each item included.*	/15

Engagement (10 marks)

Marking guideline:	Comments
Quantity (5 marks): *Participating in the majority of activities will ensure full marks for this section*	/5
Quality (5 marks): *Demonstrating engagement with the task and the use of content from the module will ensure full marks for this section*	/5

Total for assignment .....